

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U18 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U14 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U16 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U18 (born after 1/1/2018!!)

Please circle: Boy or Girl

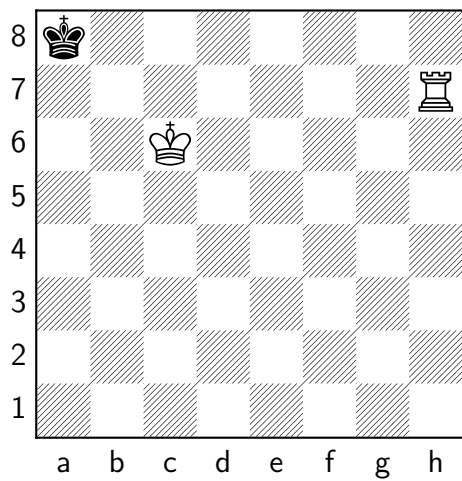
Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, try to show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.

- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example 1. Mate in two.

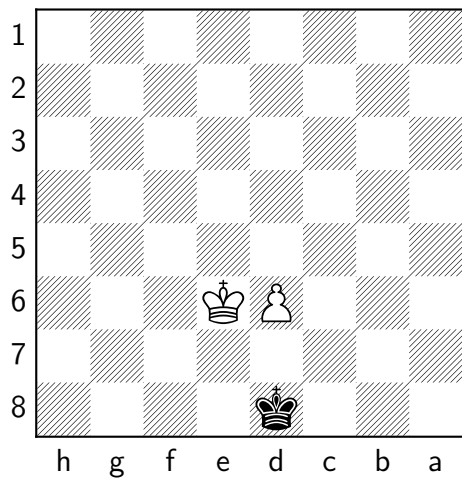


□ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8
2. Rh8# (1-0)

Example 2. Black moves and draws.



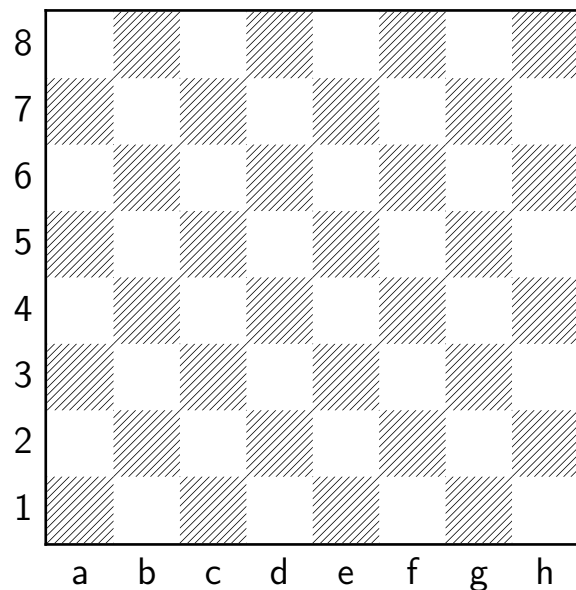
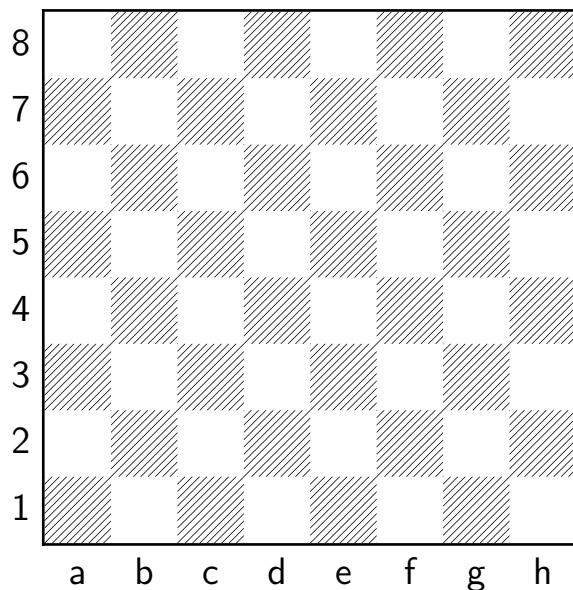
■ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw)

Q14. 8 Queens Independent puzzle. Place 8 queens on the board so that all 8 Queens don't attack each other. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 4,426,165,368 (${}_{64}C_8$) patterns to place 8 queens on the board. Among those pattern, only 92 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took 8 minutes 20 seconds to complete this task. Can you beat him?

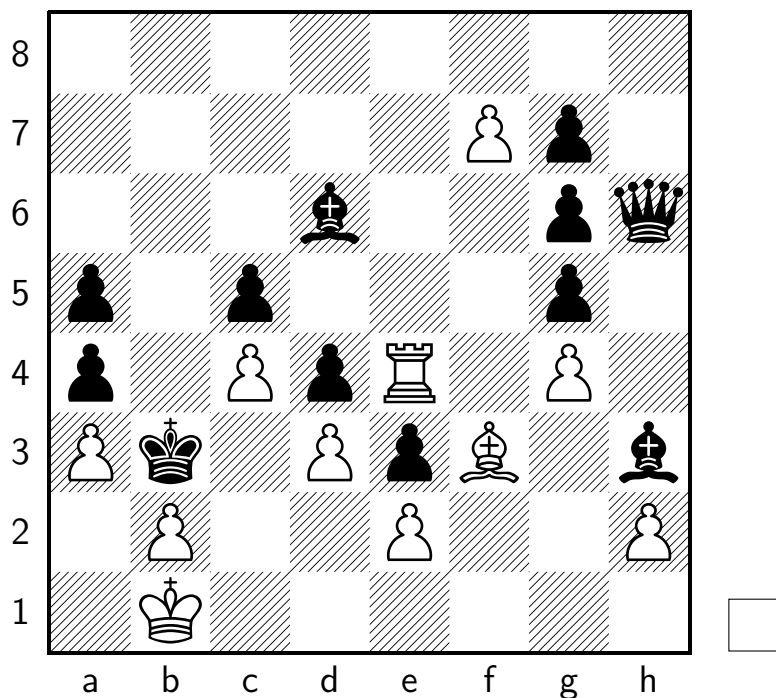


Answer:

Fill 8 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, write a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in six. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and is a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

1 ♖e7! ♙×e7 2 f8♚ ♙×f8 3 ♙c6 ♚h4 4 ♙×a4+ ♙×a4 5 ♙a2 ♚e1 6 b3#

Intention: Sacrifice for Bishop's path, block Queen's path, and setting up mate. (Hard?)

Source: "Grandmaster Solves Grandmaster-Level Puzzles" from Daniel Naroditsky's YouTube channel. The puzzle itself is puzzle ID925 of Chess.com (rating 3020 at the time).